

Gen 9 tablets

Archos to come up with Gen 9 tablets this summer which will compete against the iPad 2

Flash Player 10.2 for Android

Adobe released Flash Player 10.2 for Android, which is the first major update in a while

Creative ZiiSound D5

Wireless freedom but average sound

There are dime-a-dozen iPod docks in the market, but Creative's ZiiSound D5 has taken this product category a notch higher. Apart from being an iPod dock, the D5 can play music wirelessly as long as its coming out of a stereo bluetooth device like your phone or your MP3 player. For iPods and iPhones, Creative bundles in a bluetooth transmitter which when attached to the iPod charging slot, transmits music wirelessly to the D5. The transmitter can also be docked in the D5 and the iPod charges as it plays. It consists of the apt-X codec which compresses the audio stream as there is a limit on the maximum A2DP bandwidth. You will require



a dongle which houses the encoder for the apt-X codec. It is present in the bluetooth transmitter for the iPod.

The ZiiSound D5 has a very sturdy build quality and comes in an all black body. There's plastic panel which runs along the centre. This plastic panel has volume controls on the top portion and a connectivity indicator in the front. On the rear you have a power connector and an Aux-In.

The D5 is quite loud and doesn't vibrate at maximum volume levels, something we

found quite prevalent in other iPod docks. Mid frequency was the most responsive, giving crystal clear sound. Bass heavy songs tended to skip some beats and sounded muffled. At higher frequencies too the sound separation was found to be lacking. Distortion was noted in some bass heavy songs at maximum volume. The USP of the D5 is wireless music playback over Bluetooth, without a remote.

At ₹17,999 it is quite expensive, innovative but not audiophile.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Frequency: 2.4GHz;
Operating Range: 10m;
Dimensions: 425 x 110 x 90 mm; Weight: 3.8 kg

Contact

Creative Technology

Phone: +91 92231 01322

Email: vinayendra.singh@compuageindia.com

Web site: www.in.creative.com

Price: ₹17,999

6.0/10

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	5.5
Build.....	7.5
Value for money.....	4.0

Specifications

Standards support: 802.11b/g; Network support: GSM Quad band, UMTS/HSDPA; Wireless Security: 64/128-bit WEP, WPA-PSK, WPA2-PSK, Built in firewall; Weight: 103gms

Contact

D-Link (India) Ltd.

Phone: +91 22 2921 5700

Email: divya.shetty@dlink.co.in

Web site: www.dlink.co.in

Price: ₹8300

6.0/10

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	5.5
Value for money.....	6.0

D-Link My Pocket Router

Surf anywhere with this 3G pocket router

D-link DIR 457 My Pocket Router is a compact, portable router which uses your 3G SIM card to connect to the internet. In essence it acts as an access point allowing you to share your 3G card's internet connection. As it's portable, it can be used anywhere as long as you are getting a 3G signal.

It comes in a thin plastic body with a glossy top and a matte bottom. There is a switch which allows you to use the DIR 457 as a Modem or a Router. As soon as you connect the router to your

system via the mini USB port, it will install a D-Link connection manager which allows you to set security passwords, check balance, import contacts among other things.

The performance impressed us with its reach despite being an 802.11g router. You will get the best speeds only if you are in the same room as the

router, but we were not disappointed with speeds in adjoining room as well. Setup can be problematic as the menus are completely different from that of a normal router, so it does involve a learning curve. It also has a microSD card slot, the data on which can be shared between different Wi-Fi enabled devices that are connected to this one.

At ₹8,300 the DIR 457 is even more pricy than some of the 802.11n routers in the market. But if portability is what you are looking for, this is the right product. It is great for those who are always on the move and extensively use 3G.

Nimish Sawant

